CV

Petter Falk

Political scientist and media scholar whose research is situated at the intersection of science and technology studies (STS), public administration research, and the emerging field of critical data studies. I hold a position as Senior Lecturer in Political Science at Karlstad University and a postdoctoral fellowship at Södertörn University, where I contribute to the Swedish Research Council project *Digital Vulnerability* and the WASP-HS cluster *The AI Welfare State*.

My research examines how interoperable infrastructures, algorithmic systems and data practices are enacted within, and reciprocally reconfigure, the Swedish welfare state. Employing ethnographic methods, I investigate the ontological politics of data in public care settings: how data practices assemble citizens, organisations and democratic processes in novel configurations, and with what consequences for vulnerability, participation and governance. My dissertation, *Assemble Care // Align Data: An Ethnographic Study of Datafication in Swedish Public Care*, ethnographically traces these socio-technical entanglements, interrogating what datafication does to the practices and ontologies of public care.

A decade of applied experience — at RISE Research Institutes of Sweden, as an investigator for the City of Karlstad, and as project leader for VINNOVA- and EU-funded projects on AI, open data and citizen participation — situates my research within the situated, material realities of public-sector practice.

Academic and professional appointments

- **Senior Lecturer, Political Science**, Karlstad University — January 2026–present. Affiliated with the Centre for Service Research (CTF) and Karlstad University Societal Impact AB. Leads research and development projects on democracy, algorithmic systems and public-sector data; teaches democratic theory, organisation theory and welfare models.
- **Postdoctoral Researcher, Media and Communication Studies**, Södertörn University — September 2025–September 2027. Works on the Swedish Research Council project *Digital Vulnerability* and is involved in the WASP-HS cluster *The AI Welfare State*.
- **Lecturer, Political Science**, Karlstad University — January 2021–2026. Affiliated with CTF and Karlstad University Societal Impact AB.
- **Project Manager**, RISE Research Institutes of Sweden — June 2016–December 2020. Managed projects concerning data-driven systems, democracy and design.
- **Data Analyst and Project Manager**, Attityd i Karlstad AB — April 2012–May 2016. Focused particularly on public-sector research and analysis.
- **Investigator**, City Executive Office, City of Karlstad — January 2009–March 2012. Conducted investigations concerning consultation and democracy.

Education

- **Doctoral studies in Political Science**, Karlstad University — 2019–2024. Dissertation: *Assemble Care // Align Data: An Ethnographic Study of Datafication in Swedish Public Care*.
- **Master's degree in Political Science**, Karlstad University — 2018.
- **Bachelor's programme in Political Science**, Karlstad University — 2007–2011.
- Hindi language studies, Banaras Hindu University / Uppsala University — 2007.
- History of Religions, courses A–D, Karlstad University — 2004–2006.

Selected publications

- Kaun, A., Arnelid, M., Falk, P., et al. (2026). "Digital vulnerabilities." *Media, Culture & Society, 48*(6), 1280–1288.
- Falk, P. (2026). Review of Maja Bak Herrie's *Thinking Through Data. Science & Technology Studies, 39*(1), 70–72.

- Falk, P. (2024). *Assemble Care // Align Data: An Ethnographic Study of Datafication in Swedish Public Care*.
- Fahimi, M., Falk, P., et al. (2024). "In/visibilities in Data Studies: Methods, Tools, and Interventions." In *Dialogues in Data Power*. Bristol University Press.
- Falk, P. (2023). "Data Matter: As Data Become Matter, Design Matters." In *The Materials of Service Design*, pp. 143–148. Edward Elgar Publishing.
- Falk, P. (2021). "Towards a Public Sector Data Culture: Data as an Individual and Communal Resource in Progressing Democracy." In *The Data Shake*. Springer.

Selected research and development projects

- **The Machine and/in the Authority: AI, Legislation, and Innovation Dynamics in Public Administration** — VINNOVA-funded project, 2025–2026.
- **AISHA and AiSecrett** — National process lead for Digital Europe projects, 2023–2025.
- **Early Insights, Early Interventions (TITI)** — Process lead; implementation of the new Swedish Social Services Act, 2023–2025.
- **System Design in Co-Operation** — Process lead; methodologies for the Swedish Transport Administration, 2021–2024.
- **Systematic Service User Involvement: Data and Integrated Care** — Project manager, 2021–2023.
- **Seeing Yourself in the Code** — Project manager; algorithmic systems and AI in social work, 2019–2020.
- **Democracy Data** — Project manager; data-driven approaches in Swedish social services, 2018–2020.
- **Open4Citizens** — Process lead; Horizon 2020 project on open data and citizen participation, 2016–2018.
- **xKRP** — Project manager; national data lab, 2016–2019.
- **UTSATT** — Project manager; gender-equality training in virtual reality, 2016–2018.

Co-wrote the approved application for **OMTÄNKT**, a VINNOVA-funded project on long-term transformation in Swedish health and social care, 2025–2028.

Teaching and supervision

Teaching at Karlstad University has included organisation theory in health and social care, the Swedish welfare state model, policy analysis, urban and regional planning as a democratic process, and leadership and disinformation. Supervision has included political science, health and medical care administration, and media and communication studies.

Contributed to the development of a master's programme. Guest lectures have included Oslo Metropolitan University, Linköping University, the University of Gothenburg and Politecnico di Milano.

Completed higher-education teaching courses in university teaching, norm-critical pedagogy, examination and feedback, sustainability, accessible learning environments and pedagogical portfolio development. Doctoral supervision training is listed as ongoing from 2025.

Selected conference presentations and invited talks

- **"Reconfiguring Vulnerability: Healthcare Interoperability and the Technoscientific Imaginaries of Datafied Care Subjects"** — 4S Annual Meeting, Toronto, October 2026.
- **"Assembling Vulnerability: Interoperability and the Ontology of Welfare Data"** — EASST Conference, Kraków, 2026.
- **"Do I Represent Data-Citizens?"** — Datafied Citizens Conference, July 2026.
- **"Reconfiguring Vulnerability: The Statecraft of/in Interoperable Welfare Systems"** — Digital Statecraft Symposium, 2026.
- **"Interoperability May Be Smart, but Is It Wise?"** — Invited talk, Gala Global Conference, October 2026.
- **"On Data and Interoperability in Welfare"** — Special guest speaker, Swedish Pensions Agency, September 2026.
- **"The Citizen and/in/through Their Data"** — Invited talk, Mötesplats Varumärken Offentlig Sektor, September 2026.
- **"Data and/in Democracy: Power, Governance and Value in Data-Driven Public Services"** — Keynote, Politecnico di Milano Expert Design Talks, April 2025.
- **"Democracy and/in the Autopilot"** — Keynote, WASP-HS Winter Conference, February 2025.
- **"Sharing, Caring, and Breaking Silos"** — Data Power Conference, 2024.
- **"AI, Data and Democracy: A Public Administration Perspective"** — Keynote, City of Karlstad, June 2024.

Public engagement and media

Organised or co-organised seminars and workshops on datafication, welfare systems, democracy and service research, including *Escape Room Välfärden* (March 2026), *Service Research and/in Capitalism* (2024) and *Doing and/in Data* (2023). A workshop on the datafication of Swedish state organisations, co-hosted with Mathias Krusell, is listed for **November 2026**.

Media contributions and appearances include *Offentliga Affärer* (2026), an opinion article in *Dagens Nyheter* (2024), Sveriges Radio Värmland (2023), the podcasts *Demokratidatapodden* and *On Data and Democracy*, and SVT Nyheter (2019).

Selected positions of trust and international experience

- Steering committee member, Changemaker Education Experience Designer Programme — 2020–2023.
- Board member, Coompanion Värmland — 2017–2020.
- Co-founder and process lead, Civic Karlstad — 2015–2018.
- Data researcher, DATA4CHAN.GE — Beirut, 2016; Tallinn, 2019.
- Civil society representative at international programmes in Portugal (2015) and Slovakia (2019).
- Participant, Swedish Institute Young Leaders Visitors Programme — Stockholm and Amman, 2013.
- Workshop facilitator and trainer at international programmes in Turkey, Japan, Hungary and the UK — 2010–2013.
- Swedish youth-organisation representative during the Slovenian, Czech and Swedish EU Council Presidencies — 2008–2009.